

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1185

By Reneau

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Peer Support Team of the Chattanooga Police Department upon its receipt of the Chief's Award.

WHEREAS, our nation was conceived by individuals who were willing to sacrifice their personal concerns to ensure the public safety and welfare, and the Volunteer State is especially proud to be the home of so many valiant individuals who have performed above and beyond the call of duty in service of public safety; and

WHEREAS, such individuals comprise the members of the Peer Support Team of the Chattanooga Police Department, who were recently honored with the Chattanooga Police Department Chief's Award, in recognition of their exemplary service and dedication; and

WHEREAS, in 2025, the Peer Support Team transformed peer support within the police department by shifting from a reactive approach to a proactive model focused on early intervention, prevention, and sustained connection, implementing initiatives such as a peer support watchlist and intentional check-ins to assist members before challenges escalate; and

WHEREAS, the team has further strengthened its professionalism through certification training and the development of a Peer Support Mentor Program for cadets, fostering a culture of wellness and trust early in a police officer's career; and

WHEREAS, members of the team have also contributed beyond traditional peer roles by assisting with policy development, supporting the Mighty Oaks Outpost, creating wellness and suicide awareness resources, and responding immediately after critical incidents; and

WHEREAS, the efforts of the Peer Support Team have made a lasting impact on the Chattanooga Police Department and the well-being of its officers; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE

CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the Peer Support Team of the Chattanooga Police Department upon its receipt of the Chief's Award.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.